CRM LEAD FUNNEL ANALYSIS

Business Analytics Internship Project

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Status	Self-Initiated Portfolio Project

TOOLS USED

Microsoft Excel · Pivot Tables · Pivot Charts · Slicers · Conditional Formatting · Dashboard Design · Business Analytics · Data Visualization

METHODOLOGY

This project was completed as part of a Business Analyst internship at an RBI-registered Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC). As the internship involved live customer data, this analysis was conducted entirely using a self-built simulated dataset to preserve data confidentiality while demonstrating full analytical capability.

A dataset of 300 leads was constructed to mirror the structure and business logic of a real NBFC lead funnel — replicating the lead statuses, rejection dispositions, source channels, salary bands, CIBIL score ranges, and city distribution that characterise a typical personal loan acquisition pipeline. The dataset was built independently, without reference to any confidential company records.

The objective of this project was to practice and demonstrate end-to-end business analytics capability, including:

- Funnel analysis and conversion rate measurement
- CRM lead classification and disposition analysis
- Excel-based dashboard design (Pivot Tables, Pivot Charts, Slicers, Conditional Formatting)
- Business insight generation and structured recommendation writing
- Portfolio-quality report production in consulting format

Confidentiality Statement

This report is based entirely on a self-generated simulated dataset. It is published solely to demonstrate analytical methodology and capability. No confidential business data, customer records, or proprietary company information has been disclosed.

TOOLS USED

Tool	Application in This Project
Microsoft Excel	Primary analysis and dashboard environment
Pivot Tables	Lead status breakdown, source analysis, rejection reason aggregation
Pivot Charts	Bar and donut visualisations of funnel and drop-off data
Slicers	Interactive filtering by source, status, and city
Conditional Formatting	Visual flagging of high-volume rejection categories
Dashboard Design	Single-view KPI and insight layout for management reporting
Data Visualisation	Comparative salary analysis, funnel flow, drop-off classification

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The following analysis examines the end-to-end performance of a 300-lead NBFC personal loan acquisition funnel. The core finding is that the funnel's primary loss mechanism is early-stage disengagement and basic ineligibility — not credit evaluation failure. This distinction has significant implications for where improvement effort should be concentrated.

300	25%	35%	~30%
Total Leads Analysed	Overall Conversion Rate	Early Drop-off Rate	Rejections from Low Salary

Of 300 leads, 75 (25%) were successfully disbursed. Early-stage drop-off — comprising leads lost to No Answer, Not Interested, and Not Eligible — accounts for 105 leads (35%), nearly three times the 39 leads lost to formal credit rejection (13%). The leading rejection driver is Low Salary, responsible for approximately 30% of all rejections, nearly double the next-largest cause.

The strategic implication is clear: the highest-leverage opportunity for conversion improvement lies at the top of the funnel — in lead targeting, landing page qualification, and telecalling reachability — rather than in the credit evaluation process itself.

1. LEAD FUNNEL ANALYSIS

The 300-lead dataset spans the full acquisition funnel from initial ad-generated enquiry through to loan disbursal. The status distribution reveals a funnel with meaningful conversion at the disbursal stage (25%), but significant volume lost in the pre-evaluation stages.

1.1 Status Distribution

Status	Count	% of Total
Fresh Lead	11	3.7%
No Answer	47	15.7%
Interested	45	15.0%
Not Interested	30	10.0%
Not Eligible	28	9.3%
Rejected	39	13.0%
Approved	14	4.7%
Disbursed	75	25.0%
Closed	11	3.7%

No Answer (47 leads, 15.7%) is the single largest non-conversion category — larger even than formal rejection (39 leads). This is a critical distinction: these leads were not disqualified on merit; they were simply unreached. This represents the funnel's largest recoverable opportunity.

1.2 Lead Source Distribution

Lead volume is broadly distributed across six acquisition channels, with Facebook Ads and Google Ads – Competitor generating the highest volumes:

Source	Count
Facebook Ads	63
Google Ads – Competitor	58
Google Ads – Generic	47
Referral	46
Google Ads – Brand	45
Organic Search	41

Volume alone does not indicate source quality. A high-volume source generating predominantly ineligible or unreachable leads represents a cost inefficiency. Source-level conversion rate analysis — feasible with real operational data — would be the logical next step.

2. REJECTION ANALYSIS

Income eligibility is the dominant barrier to conversion. Of the 67 leads marked Rejected or Not Eligible, income-related causes account for nearly half — a pattern with direct implications for ad targeting strategy.

Rejection Reason	Count	Category
Low Salary	20	Income / Eligibility
Self Employed	11	Income / Eligibility
Low CIBIL	9	Credit Risk
No Official Email	8	Documentation
No Payslip	6	Documentation
Existing Customer	5	Other
Documentation Issues	4	Documentation
Out of Location	4	Logistics

Grouping by root cause category clarifies the picture:

- Income / Eligibility (Low Salary + Self Employed): 31 leads — the largest category by a significant margin
- Documentation (No Official Email + No Payslip + Documentation Issues): 18 leads
- Credit Risk (Low CIBIL): 9 leads
- Other / Logistics: 9 leads

Key Insight

Income eligibility issues (31 leads) outweigh documentation and credit-risk causes combined (27 leads). This suggests that a proportion of rejections could be prevented upstream through more precise lead targeting — before a telecaller invests time in qualification.

3. NOT ELIGIBLE ANALYSIS

28 leads (9.3% of total) were disqualified at the pre-evaluation stage — filtered out before a formal application or credit check was initiated. This is operationally distinct from the 39 leads formally Rejected after evaluation.

Category	Count	Key Distinction
Not Eligible	28	Filtered early — minimal processing cost per lead
Rejected	39	Failed after evaluation — telecalling + credit review already absorbed

While Not Eligible leads consume comparatively little resource before exit, their volume signals a targeting gap: leads that should have been screened out at the landing page stage are instead entering the CRM and consuming initial telecalling effort. The more cost-effective fix is to prevent these leads from entering the pipeline at all — through a lightweight pre-screening mechanism on the landing page.

4. NO ANSWER ANALYSIS

Largest Recoverable Opportunity

The single largest non-conversion category in this funnel is not rejection — it is reachability. 47 leads (15.7%) never responded to telecalling, representing an operational gap rather than a lead-quality problem.

Unlike Rejected or Not Eligible leads, a No Answer lead carries no negative signal about creditworthiness or eligibility. These are prospective borrowers who expressed enough interest to submit a form, but were subsequently unreachable. Their failure to convert is an execution issue — one that is more tractable than changing the profile of who the funnel attracts.

The primary lever is telecalling contact strategy: call timing, number of retry attempts, time between retries, and channel diversification (e.g., SMS or WhatsApp follow-up). Each of these is an internal operational variable, entirely within the company's control. With real data, a time-of-day analysis on successful contacts versus No Answer contacts would likely identify actionable patterns.

5. LEAD QUALITY INSIGHTS

5.1 Salary as a Conversion Predictor

Average monthly salary differs materially between leads that converted and leads that were rejected — confirming that income level is a genuine, not incidental, predictor of disbursal outcome:

Segment	Average Monthly Salary (₹)
Disbursed Leads	37,933
Rejected Leads	33,025
Differential	4,908 (~15% higher among converted leads)

A ₹4,908 average salary differential between disbursed and rejected leads is not incidental — it is statistically consistent with Low Salary being the leading rejection driver. This validates salary as an early-stage signal that could be used to score or pre-qualify leads before full telecalling engagement.

5.2 Early vs Late Drop-off Classification

Classifying funnel exits by stage of loss — rather than by individual status — provides a cleaner picture of where intervention would be most effective:

Drop-off Stage	Count	% of Total	Definition
Early Drop-off	105	35.0%	Not Eligible, No Answer, Not Interested — lost before formal evaluation
Late Drop-off	39	13.0%	Rejected after credit / document evaluation
Converted / Progressed	100	33.3%	Disbursed, Approved, or Closed
In Progress	56	18.7%	Fresh Lead or Interested — still active

Strategic Implication

Early Drop-off (105 leads) is nearly 3× Late Drop-off (39 leads). The majority of funnel losses occur before formal evaluation begins — meaning the highest-leverage fixes are upstream: in targeting, qualification, and reachability — not in credit policy or documentation requirements.

6. KEY BUSINESS INSIGHTS

1. The funnel's primary loss mechanism is early-stage, not late-stage. Leads are being lost to disengagement and basic ineligibility before they reach credit evaluation. This means adjusting credit policy or documentation requirements — the instinctive fix — would address the wrong problem. The correct intervention point is higher in the funnel.
2. Income eligibility is the dominant rejection driver, outweighing documentation and credit-score issues combined. Low Salary and Self Employed together account for 31 of 67 rejections. This is a targeting signal: the current lead-generation approach is attracting a material proportion of applicants who will fail on the first eligibility criterion applied.
3. No Answer represents an operational gap, not a lead-quality gap. 47 leads — 15.7% of the total, more than the formal rejection rate — were simply unreachable. Unlike ineligible or rejected leads, these applicants expressed interest and submitted forms. Their non-conversion is recoverable through improved contact strategy.
4. Salary is a validated early predictor of conversion. The ₹4,908 average salary differential between disbursed and rejected leads confirms that income level should be treated as a lead-scoring input, not merely a post-submission eligibility check.

7. IMPROVEMENT RECOMMENDATIONS

The following recommendations are derived directly from the funnel analysis above. They are sequenced by estimated impact and implementation urgency.

HIGH IMPACT

1. Refine paid advertising targeting toward higher-income audience segments. Low Salary is the single largest rejection driver (~30% of all rejections). Tightening the income profile of the audience reached by Google and Facebook campaigns would reduce the volume of ineligible leads entering the funnel and lower cost-per-qualified-lead.
2. Introduce income and location pre-screening at the landing page stage, before a lead enters the CRM. A lightweight qualification gate — requiring applicants to confirm their salary range and city before submitting contact details — would prevent Not Eligible leads from consuming telecalling resources, reducing wasted operational effort at negligible acquisition cost.

OPERATIONAL IMPROVEMENTS

3. Audit telecalling contact strategy to address the No Answer segment. 47 leads (15.7%) were unreachable — more than the formal rejection volume. A structured review of call timing, retry frequency, and the use of alternative contact channels (SMS, WhatsApp) is likely to recover a meaningful proportion of these leads without any change to eligibility criteria.
4. Establish a dedicated workflow for Self Employed applicants with documentation requirements calibrated to their income verification constraints. Applying salaried-employee criteria to self-employed leads produces disproportionate rejection from documentation barriers that are, in principle, addressable — rather than from genuine creditworthiness failure.

8. FUTURE SCOPE

This analysis was conducted on a self-built simulated dataset. The analytical framework — funnel classification, drop-off stage analysis, rejection categorisation, and lead quality scoring — is directly applicable to real CRM data. With access to live or anonymised operational data, the following extensions would materially deepen the analysis:

- Call-timing analysis: testing whether No Answer rates vary systematically by time of day or day of week, to optimise telecalling scheduling
- Source-level conversion rate analysis: assessing disbursal rate and average lead quality by acquisition channel, rather than raw volume alone — a critical input for marketing budget allocation
- City and geography-level performance: examining whether drop-off causes vary by market to determine whether a single national intervention strategy is appropriate or whether city-specific approaches are warranted
- Time-to-conversion analysis: measuring average time from lead generation to disbursal by source and status path, to identify process bottlenecks
- Lead scoring model: using the salary differential finding as a starting point for a simple rule-based lead score, assigning probability weights to early-stage eligibility signals

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This document is published solely to demonstrate analytical methodology, business writing capability, and data visualisation proficiency. It is intended for inclusion in a public portfolio and does not represent the views, operations, or performance of any organisation.

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